

Task 1: Workplace Orientation & Problem Analysis

Problem Statement

The current student support system relies on manual tracking through emails and spreadsheets. This leads to delays, duplication, missing tickets, inconsistent data, and no clear reporting. As a result, urgent issues are overlooked, managers lack visibility, and there is no evidence trail for auditing.

Stakeholder List

- **IT Support Staff:** responsible for logging, updating, and resolving tickets.
- **IT Manager:** oversees ticket progress, monitors performance, and ensures urgent issues are escalated.
- **Students:** submit support requests and rely on timely resolution.
- **College Administration:** requires reports for auditing and compliance.

Current Process (Manual System)

- Students email support requests.
- IT staff manually track issues in spreadsheets.
- Updates are inconsistent and often missed.
- No centralised dashboard or reporting.
- Difficult to prioritise urgent issues.

Problems & Proposed Solutions

Problem	Proposed Solution
Support requests are lost in emails	Central ticket capture form with unique ticket ID
Difficult to identify urgent issues	Priority field and priority filtering
Managers cannot see progress	Dashboard and summary report
Data is inconsistent	Validation rules and controlled lists
No evidence for auditing	Test results, version logs, and documentation

Risks & Limitations

- **Incorrect Data Entry:** users may input invalid student numbers or incomplete descriptions.
- **Privacy Breaches:** sensitive student information must be protected.
- **Lack of Backups:** data loss risk if the database is not backed up.
- **User Resistance:** staff may prefer the old email/spreadsheet method.
- **Limited Scope:** initial prototype may not scale for large volumes of tickets.